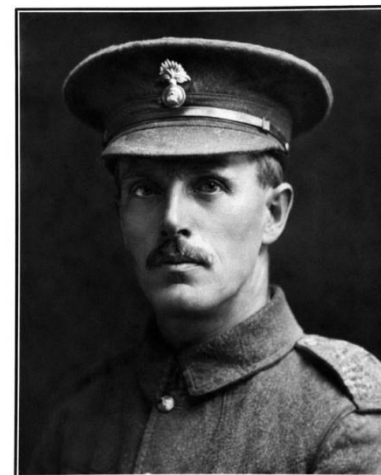




Arthur William “Joey” Parker

1878 – 1918

Civilian Research

Field Name	Field Data	Source of data
Casualty Name	A W Parker Arthur William Parker Nickname "Joey"	School plaque Harrow Observer obituary (below) and Probate (see below) Harrow Observer obituary (below)
Date of Birth	1878 Kentish Town	FreeBMD CWGC
Date of Death (from Spreadsheet)	14/3/1918	CWGC
Age at death	38 39	Harrow Observer obituary (below) CWGC
Marital Status	Mabel Mary Parker (nee Titchener) married 1904	Probate (see below) and FreeBMD
Children (if any)	1 son, Derek Arthur Parker bn 1905	FreeBMD

Occupation prior to Call up	After school worked for Credit Lyonnais then moved onto Messrs Whitbread & Co Clerk at a Brewers, age 22	Harrow Observer obituary (below) 1901 census
Parents	Mr William Somers Parker and Hannah Parker (nee Bradberry) of Roxborough Ave, Harrow	Harrow Observer obituary (below) and FreeBMD
Listed Address(s)	87 Salisbury Road, Harrow 15 Sheepcote Road, Harrow	Harrow Observer obituary (below) and Probate (below) 1901 census
Parents /Fathers occupation	Book publisher	1901 census
Brothers and Sisters	Eva Parker, Lucy Parker, Amy Parker, Sidney Parker, Hannah Parker, Ida Parker (all younger). Arthur was the eldest.	1901 census
Years at John Lyon School		
University (if any)		
Obituary	See below	Harrow Observer
Additional sources of data		
War Memorials:	Possibly: St George's Church war memorial window as Arthur William Parker	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11136
	John Lyon School, plaque	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11204
	John Lyon School, sundial	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11318
	Harrow on the Hill war memorial	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11092
	Possibly Credit Lyonnais as he worked there briefly but the list of names is not publicly available online	
	Couldn't find a Whitbread & Co list online only a memorial plaque with no names	
Activity	Very active footballer and cricketer as mentioned in obituary	Harrow Observer

Military Research

JLS WWI RoH	PARKER A.W.
CWGC Reference	https://www.cwgc.org/find-war-dead/casualty/290801/parker,-/
Age	39
DoD	14-Mar-18
Rank	Pte
Regiment	Royal Fusiliers 24th Bn
Organisations must have served or have members who served in the Ypres Salient or the Somme in World War One.	GREVILLERS BRITISH CEMETERY
Location	GREVILLERS BRITISH CEMETERY - France
Military details	Son of William and Hannah Parker; husband of Mabel Parker, of 87, Salisbury Rd., Harrow. Born at Kentish Town, London. Private Arthur William Parker (Service Number 52032) died on March 14, 1918, at the age of 39. He served with the 24th (2nd Sportsman's) Battalion of the Royal Fusiliers (City of London Regiment). Private Parker is buried at the Commonwealth War Graves Commission (CWGC) Grevillers British Cemetery in France (Plot XI, Row B, Grave 11). The cemetery is located near the village of Grevillers, in the Pas-de-Calais region of northern France, just west of Bapaume. He died of wounds sustained in action. In mid-March 1918, the 24th Battalion was holding frontline trenches in the Vacquerie Centre sub-section of the sector (near the Cambrai/Bapaume front). While the massive German Spring Offensive did not officially launch until March 21, the preceding weeks were marked by intense, daily trench-mortar bombardments, localized raids, and heavy artillery shelling as both sides jockeyed for position. Private Parker was wounded during these localized frontline exchanges and evacuated to a nearby casualty clearance post or field ambulance unit in the Grevillers sector, where he succumbed to his injuries

Story of Sacrifice

Arthur William "Joey" Parker (1878 – 1818)

Arthur William Parker, known to family and friends as "Joey", was born in Kentish Town in 1878, the eldest child of William Somers Parker, a book publisher, and Hannah Parker. He grew up in Harrow with his six younger siblings and later married Mabel Mary Titchener in 1904. Together they had one son, Derek Arthur Parker.

Civilian Life

Joey was educated at John Lyon School, where he established a reputation as an accomplished sportsman. After leaving school, he worked first for Crédit Lyonnais before spending many years with Messrs. Whitbread & Co., where he was employed as a clerk. Beyond his working life, he remained closely associated with Harrow's sporting community. He played football for Harrow Town, Stanmore and the Old Lyonians Club, and was an accomplished cricketer for Belton Club and later the Crusaders (now Harrow Cricket Club), regularly leading the batting averages. Contemporary accounts recorded that a full record of his sporting achievements would have filled the pages of The Lyonian.

After his school days were over Joey played football for some years with Harrow Town, then in their palmy days, with Stanmore, and, later, with the Old Lyonians Club. To the last game he played, he retained his marvelous quickness of footwork. At cricket for years he played with the Belton Club, and during midsummer holidays he put up some remarkable scores. The Saffrons, at Eastbourne, was one of his happy hunting grounds. He piled up scores there against the best South country eleven. Latterly he played regularly for the Crusaders, now the Harrow Cricket Club, and he usually headed the batting averages. In fact, a full list of his performances with bat and ball would furnish his old school's magazine, The Lyonian, with a remarkable athletic record.

Military Life

In 1916, although approaching the upper age limit for enlistment, Joey volunteered for military service. He served as Private 52032 with the 24th (2nd Sportsman's) Battalion, Royal Fusiliers (City of London Regiment). He spent approximately fifteen months on the front line and, despite being encouraged to accept a commission, remained in the ranks throughout his service. In mid-March 1918, the 24th Battalion was holding frontline trenches in the Vacquerie Centre sub-section of the sector (near the Cambrai/Bapaume front). While the massive German Spring Offensive did not officially launch until March 21, the preceding weeks were marked by intense, daily trench-mortar bombardments, localized raids, and heavy artillery shelling as both sides jockeyed for position. Private Parker was wounded during these localized frontline exchanges during fighting near the Cambrai–Bapaume front. He was evacuated to a nearby casualty clearance post or field ambulance unit in the Grevillers sector, where he died of his wounds on 14 March 1918, aged thirty-nine. He was buried in Grevillers British Cemetery, Pas-de-Calais, France (Plot XI, Row B, Grave 11.)

His widow, Mabel, and their son survived him.

Tributes from his friends

His obituary in the Harrow Observer recorded the esteem in which he was held in Harrow, and paints a vivid picture of Joey.

"There was no one so well-known as "Joey" Parker, no one more highly respected and loved, of one more strongly imbued with the best traditions

of the Lower School of John Lyon.”

“He was a standing example of patriotism. Though 36 years of age he never hesitated when the call came. He saw his duty clearly and did it readily and voluntarily, as he had always done.” the obituary continues “ [He]left behind him the memory of an upright, noble character, for whom the country, and Harrow in particular, has cause to be thankful.”

“To all of us who know him, the thought that we shall never again see his alert, trim figure, and his cheerful smile, gives us more than the momentary pang. His is a memory we will not "willingly let die." That his life, full of hope and full of promise, should thus be cut off, even on the field of honour, is one of the poignant tragedies of this most horrible war.”

Our deepest sympathy goes out to his wife—who is the eldest daughter of Mr. J. H. Kitchener, master of Harrow School—and her son, and to his bereaved family, in their loss.

IN MEMORIAM. The Late Arthur Parker.

Golden heart, true heart, Harrow's stalwart son,
Passed untimely to the distant bourne!
Yours the victor's laurel wreath, yours the conquest won,
Comrades of the old days for you mourn.

Great heart, high heart, warrior unashamed,
But since Harrow's brave's paid the debt,
Debt we all in turn must pay, have we ever rued
Any loss like yours—we'll not forget!

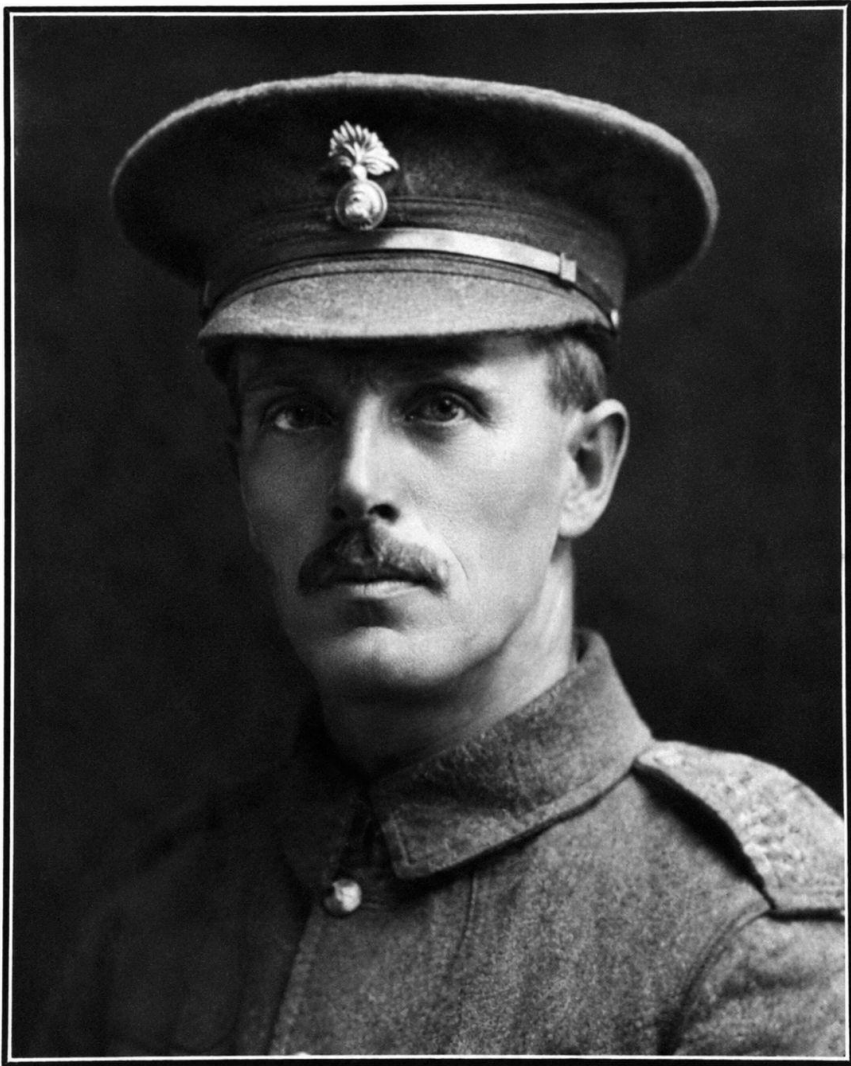
So, we'll not forget you; how, in days of yore,
Fleet of foot, you fledted across the ground;
How you hit out the winning goal and topped the highest score—
While your wondrous prowess did resound!

Child of sorrow—child of boys, valiant in the fight,
Filled with ardent faith and love of you;
Harrow Town shall keep your prowess ever in the light—
One who marched breast forward—played the game!

G. B. B.

Langley-road, Harrow, 28th March, 1918”

Photo



Parker Photo AI



Parker Photo Original

Notes and Clippings

22/3/1918 Harrow Observer

PTE. A. W. PARKER, R.F.
KILLED IN ACTION.

It is with the profoundest regret that we record the death, killed in action, in France, of Private A. W. Parker, R.F., of 67, Salisbury-road, Harrow, and son of Mr. W. S. Parker, of Roxborough-avenue, Harrow. The sad news reached his friends that he had been severely wounded in the stomach, on Wednesday, and later came the telegram that he had passed away, conscious to the very last. The blow was a severe one, for he had many relatives and a host of friends all over the district. There was no one so well-known as "Joey" Parker, more more highly respected and loved, or one more strongly imbued with the best traditions of the Lower School of John Lyon. To use a homely expression he was a white man



through and through. He was a clean sportsman, an upright conscientious citizen, a loving father, a manly Englishman. He was a standing example of patriotism. Though 36 years of age he never hesitated when the call came. He saw his duty clearly, and did it readily and voluntarily, as he had always done, and over 18 in the ranks though pressed to take a commission. For about 15 months he served in the firing line, and about three weeks ago he came home on a short leave. The writer was among those who wished him "good luck" at the station on his return, and now, in the space of a few short days, he has paid the greatest of all prices. He has, however, left behind him the memory of an upright, noble character, for whom the country, and to his bereaved family, in their loss.

A GREAT CRICKETER.
After his school days were over he played football for some years with Harrow town, then in their palmy days, with Stanmore, and later, with the Old Lyonians Club. To the last game he played, he retained his marvellous quickness of footwork. At cricket for years he played with the Belton Club, and during the summer tours, he put up some remarkable scores. The Saffrons, at Eastbourne, was one of his happy hunting grounds. He piled some centuries there against the best South country eleven. Latterly, he played regularly for the Messrs. now the Harrow Cricket Club, and he usually headed the batting averages. In fact, a full list of his performances with bat and ball would furnish his old school's magazine, The Lyonian, with remarkable athletic record.
After leaving school he was for some time engaged with the Credit Lyonnaise, but for many years he was with Messrs. Whitebread and Co. He joined up in 1916, although he was verging on the age limit, but, as all who knew him would expect, at the call of duty he was determined to have his share in the fight for righteousness.

IN MEMORIAM.
THE LATE ARTHUR PARKER.
Golden heart, lion heart, Harrow's stalwart son,
Passed untimely to the distant bourne!
Yours the victor's laurel wreath, yours the conquest won,
Comrades of the old days for you mourn.
Great heart, high heart, warrior unashamed,
Not since Harrow's brave's paid the debt,
Debt we all in turn must pay, have we ever rued
Any loss like yours—we'll not forget!
No, we'll not forget you; how, in days of yore,
Fleet of foot, you fleeted across the ground;
How you hit out the winning goal and topped the highest score—
While your wondrous prowess did resound!
Child of sorrow—child of boys, valiant in the fight,
Filled with ardent faith and love of you;
Harrow Town shall keep your prowess ever in the light—
One who marched breast forward—played the game!
G. B. B.
Langley-road, Harrow, 18th March, 1918.

(WARNING, this transcript contains an idiom from the era which some people might find offensive)

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It is with the profoundest regret that we record the death, killed in action, in France, of Private A. W. Parker, R.F., of 67, Salisbury-road, Harrow, and son of Mr. W. S. Parker, of Roxborough-avenue, Harrow. The sad news reached his friends that he had been severely wounded in the stomach, on Wednesday, and later came the telegram that he had passed away, conscious to the very last. The blow was a severe one, for he had many relatives and a host of friends all over the district. There was no one so well-known as "Joey" Parker, no one more highly respected and loved, of one more strongly imbued

with the best traditions of the Lower School of John Lyon. To use a homely expression he was a white man through and through. He was a clean sportsman, an upright, conscientious citizen, a loving brother, a manly Englishman. He was a standing example of patriotism. Though 36 years of age he never hesitated when the call came.

He saw his duty clearly and did it readily and voluntarily, as he had always done, and over 18 in the ranks though pressed to take a commission. For about 15 months he served in the firing line, and about three weeks ago he came home on a short leave. The writer was among those who wished him "good luck" at the station on his return, and now, in the space of a few short days he he has paid the greatest of all prices. He has, however, left behind him the memory of an upright, noble character, for whom the country, and Harrow in particular, has cause to be thankful.

A Great Cricketer.

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To all of us who know him, the thought that we shall never again see his alert, trim figure, and his cheerful smile, gives us more than the momentary pang. His is a memory we will not "willingly let die." That his life, full of hope and full of promise, should thus be cut off, even on the field of honour, is one of the poignant tragedies of this most horrible war.

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Child of sorrow—child of boys, valiant in the fight,
Filled with ardent faith and love of you;
Harrow Town shall keep your prowess ever in the light—
One who marched breast forward—played the game!

G. B. B.
Langley-road, Harrow, 28th March, 1918.

Probate

Parker Probate	
Probate 1918 – does confirm his middle name	
PARKER Arthur William of 87 Salisbury-road Harrow Middlesex private Royal Fusiliers died 14 March 1918 in France Probate London 8 May to Mabel Mary Parker widow. Effects £303 9s. 8d.	PARKER Arthur William of 87 Salisbury-road Harrow Middlesex private Royal Fusiliers died 14 March 1918 in France Probate London 8 May to Mabel Mary Parker widow. Effects £303 9s. 8d.